

Post a Letter

Indian Postal Service officer Disha Pannu and her 14-member team of women riders, did a bike rally to rekindle the lost art of letter writing

So, a rally to spur children to post letters.
The campaign is part of India Post's initiative to revive the joy and personal touch of handwritten letters, especially among children. We want to bring back the timeless tradition of writing letters. India Post organises an annual national-level letter writing competition, Dhai Akhar. There were three special themes in this rally—Message for Modi, Sandesh to Scindia and Pen to Pemmasani. Our 14-member team of women riders travelled over 2,000 km across various south Indian cities, including Bengaluru, Puducherry, Rameswaram, Kanyakumari, Munnar and Mysuru. Along the way, we interacted with many schoolchildren, and distributed four specially designed postcards. Thousands of children wrote heartfelt messages to the leaders on these postcards.

Tell us more about your team of riders.
The group included women from diverse professional backgrounds. So we had a pilot, a gynaecologist, a child educator, entrepreneurs and lawyers. This diversity also showcased the limitless potential of women.

How did you become a biker?
I have been a national-level sportsperson. While bikes always fascinated me, this year I learnt to ride them through 'Lets Ryde' in Gurgaon, which is dedicated to empowering women by supporting their journeys.

with Neha Kirpal

GRAND OPENINGS

Four new properties in India and abroad

THE LOTUS PALACE CHETTINAD



Park Hotels' new heritage property, The Lotus Palace Chettinad in Tamil Nadu, is an architectural marvel from the late 17th century. The 15-room palace, with its Raja Ravi Varma-influenced stained-glass panels, was a revered location for Ramayana recitals for over 100 years. Among other facilities, guests can enjoy the fine-dining restaurant, 86 Pillars, which celebrates Chettinad cuisine. ₹20,000 onwards per night, plus taxes; www.theparkhotels.com



ARQ BY THE LEELA

The Leela group recently unveiled its exclusive villa spaces at the iconic Leela Palace, Udaipur. Nestled along the shores of Lake Pichola, Arq is an intimate high-end luxury villa sanctuary for the discerning traveller. The hyper-personalised 'palace within a palace' offers curated programming customised for each guest, from private culinary journeys to artistic immersions. ₹3,51,000-₹6,01,000 per night; www.theleela.com

IHCL YARKAY THIMPHU



South Asia's largest hospitality company recently announced the opening of Yarkay, Thimphu - IHCL SeleQtions in Bhutan. Inspired by Bhutan's beloved folktale of the Four Friends, the interiors of the 83-key hotel are a celebration of Bhutanese culture and values. Guests can indulge in the all-day dining restaurant or explore authentic Bhutanese flavours at Zachum. Rs 36,100-51,620 per night; www.seleqtionshotels.com



AMAN MALDIVES

The Aman group is opening its 21st destination and the latest addition to its 35-strong collection next year. The Aman Maldives will feature a 52-key resort and 16 branded residencies and will be situated in one of the most secluded parts of the Maldives. Designed by long-time Aman collaborator, Kerry Hill Architects, it will house restaurants, a beach club, an expansive spa and a dive centre among other attractions. www.aman.com

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